

3.3 Characteristics of the tropical rainforest ecosystem

- 1 Copy and complete Table 3.2 to show the vertical layers of tropical rainforests.

Layer	Approximate height above ground (metres)
	0
	0 to 5
	10 to 20
	30
	Up to 40

Table 3.2: Vertical layers within the tropical rainforest

- 2 Match the features of rainforest vegetation with the correct image.

epiphytes

A



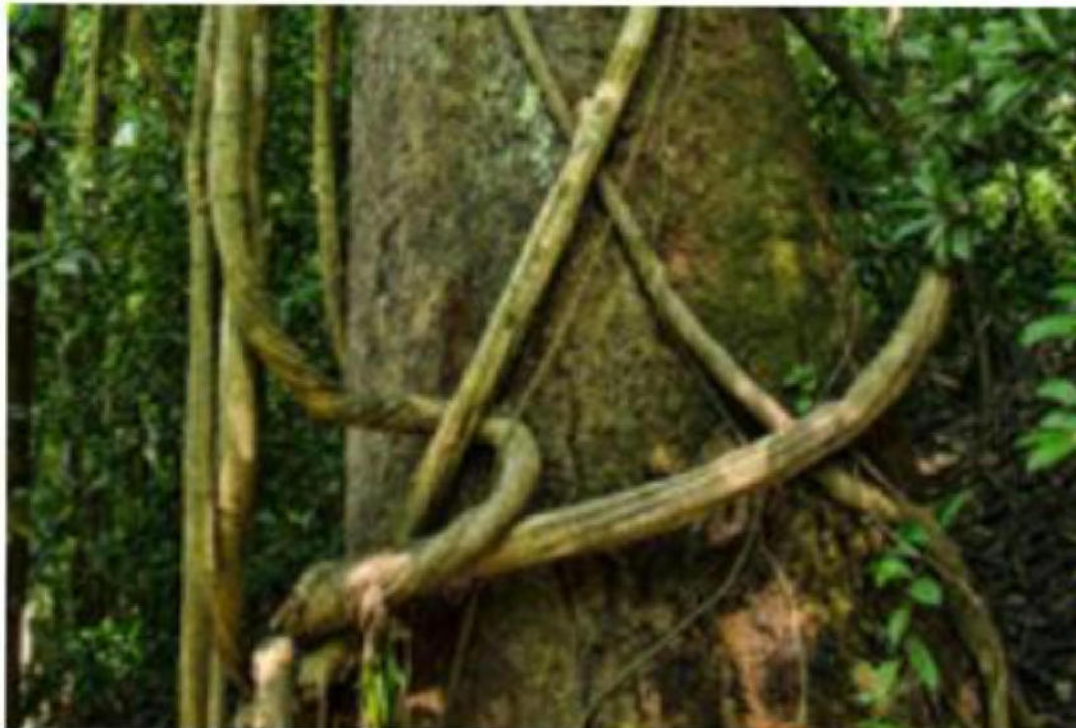
lianas

B



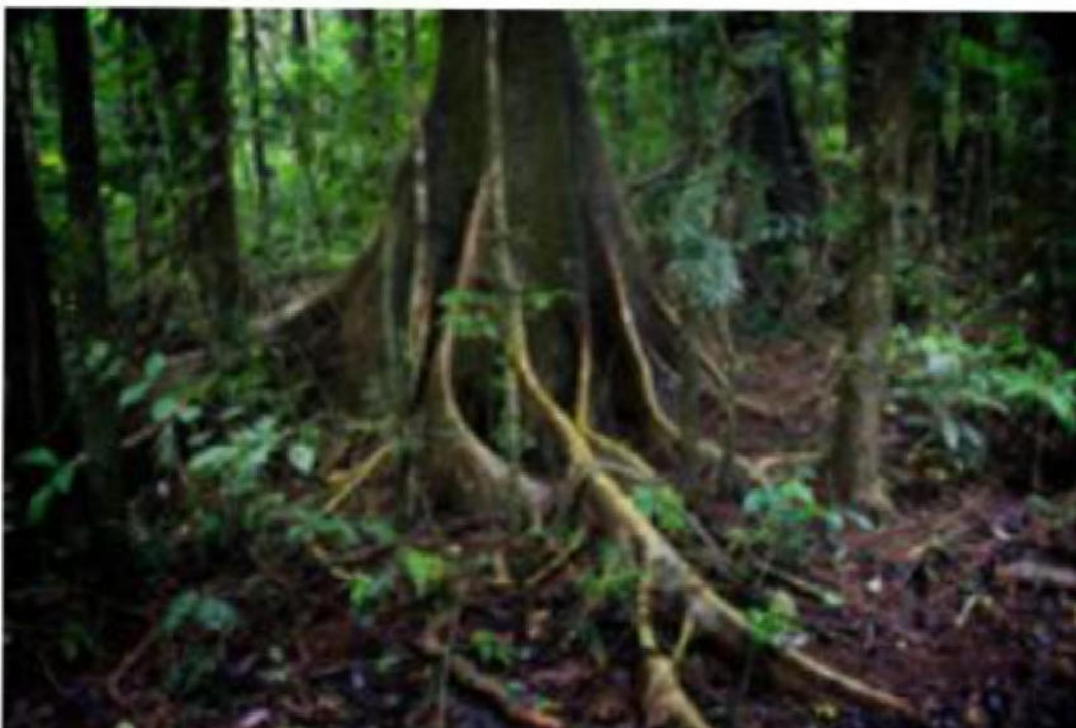
buttress roots

C



tree ferns

D



3 What adaptations have plants developed to survive in tropical rainforests?

Use the skills that you've already developed in this topic to attempt the following questions.

- 4** Sketch a diagram to show why the air above the tropical rainforests is usually hot and wet. [5]
- 5** Discuss how abiotic factors influence plants and animals in tropical rainforests. [7]

◀◀ **RECALL AND CONNECT 3** ▶▶

Cacao is a tree that grows in the Amazon Rainforest and other tropical rainforest areas. Cacao is used to make chocolate and other products like cocoa butter. It is a valuable resource that can help a country to develop. See if you can answer these questions linked to [Topic 8, 'The challenge of development'](#).

- a** What is Fairtrade?
- b** What products are often labelled 'Fairtrade' and how do farmers benefit from Fairtrade?
- c** What are the limitations of Fairtrade initiatives in low-income and middle-income countries?